

Hard Times

Stephen Foster (1826-1864)

This musical score is for the song "Hard Times" by Stephen Foster, presented in 4/4 time. It uses a guitar fretboard notation system where numbers below the staff indicate fret positions for each note. The score is divided into eight systems, each containing a musical staff and a corresponding sequence of fret numbers. Some notes are beamed together, and some are marked with a tilde (~) to indicate a slide or a specific articulation. The fret numbers range from -5 to +9, representing frets below and above the open string.

System 1 (Measures 1-3):
Fret sequence: +5, -5, +6, +6, -5, +6, +7, ~, +6

System 2 (Measures 4-6):
Fret sequence: -5, +5, +5, -5, +5, +6, +9, -7, +7, +6, +5

System 3 (Measures 7-9):
Fret sequence: -5, +5, +6, -5, +5, ~, +5, -5, +6, +6, -5

System 4 (Measures 10-12):
Fret sequence: +6, +7, ~, +6, -5, +5, +5, -5, +5, +6, +9, -7

System 5 (Measures 13-15):
Fret sequence: +7, +6, +5, -5, +5, +6, -5, +5, ~, +6, -6

System 6 (Measures 16-18):
Fret sequence: +7, +7, +7, -6, +7, -7, +7, +9, -7, +7

System 7 (Measures 19-21):
Fret sequence: +6, -5, +5, -5, +5, -5, +6, -5, +5, -5, +6, +6, -5

System 8 (Measures 22-24):
Fret sequence: +6, +7, ~, +6, -5, +5, +5, -5, +5, +6, +9, -7

2
30

A musical staff in treble clef containing ten measures. The notes and their corresponding fret numbers are: Measure 1: quarter note G4 (+7); Measure 2: eighth note F#4 (+6); Measure 3: dotted quarter note E4 (+5); Measure 4: dotted quarter note D4 (-5); Measure 5: eighth note C4 (+5); Measure 6: quarter note B3 (+6); Measure 7: quarter note A3 (-5); Measure 8: half note G4 (+5) with a slur over the next measure; Measure 9: quarter note F#4 (~); Measure 10: quarter rest. The staff ends with a double bar line.

+7 +6 +5 -5 +5 +6 -5 +5 ~